

Nicole Jenkins

PhD Student



About me

Building on my Bachelor of Astronomical and Space Sciences (Honours) with a minor in Data Analytics at the University of Southern Queensland, I am now pursuing a PhD in Astronomy with a focus on the distribution of star formation in merging galaxies. My research combines rigorous scientific inquiry with advanced data analysis techniques, reflecting my passion for uncovering new insights into the universe. Alongside my academic work, I am dedicated to science communication and outreach, actively engaging with the public to make astronomy accessible and inspiring to diverse audiences. I aim to leverage both my technical expertise and commitment to outreach to contribute meaningfully to astronomical research, education, and community engagement.

Contact

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- Car Available, Driving License

Languages

- English - Native Language

EDUCATION

Current



PhD Student

Toowoomba, QLD

UniSQ

Postgraduate HDR Student

Conducting research focused on continuing Honours research into the distribution of star formation in merging galaxies. Combining advanced data analytics with astronomical datasets to investigate fundamental questions in astrophysics. Active in outreach and science communication initiatives.

2018-2025



Bachelor of Science (Honours)

Toowoomba, QLD

UniSQ

Undergraduate

Major in Astronomical and Space Sciences with a minor in Data Analytics. Honours thesis investigated the distribution of star formation in merging galaxies. Developed strong skills in statistical analysis, coding workflows, and scientific visualisation.

2014



Diploma of Digital Media Technology

Brisbane, QLD

Evocca Academy

Student

Training in digital media production, design, and technology application. Gained experience in creative workflows, visual communication, and technical problem-solving.

2011-2012



Certificate IV Veterinary Nursing

Tamworth, NSW

TAFE NSW

Student Vet Nurse

Undertook clinical training in veterinary nursing while working at Noah's Ark Veterinary Clinic, Medowie. Developed practical skills in patient care, teamwork, professional communication, and sensitive stock handling.

WORK EXPERIENCE

2015-2022

Senior Photographer & Co-Editor

QLD, Australia

Australian Motorsport Magazine

Organised motorsport events and coordinated staff safety training and protocols. Conducted driver interviews, photographed races and events, and produced written articles and feature stories for publication. Oversaw editorial processes and contributed to magazine content strategy.

2013-2014

Animal Attendant & Front of House Darling Downs, QLD

Darling Downs Zoo

Provided daily animal care and handling, including feeding, enrichment, and enclosure maintenance. Assisted with guest intake and customer service, managed cash handling, and supported food preparation. Ensured high standards of hygiene and safety across zoo operations.

2011-2012

Veterinary Nurse

Medowie, NSW

Noah's Ark Veterinary Clinic

Supported veterinarians in surgical procedures, administered medications, and assisted with animal handling including horses. Delivered patient care, performed bathing and cleaning duties, and maintained clinical standards. Gained experience in both small and large animal practice.

Soft Skills and Strengths

Creativity

Curiosity

Flexibility

Self Confidence

Ability to Plan and Organize

Autonomy

Adaptability

Eye for Details

Problem Solving

Teamwork

Love Learning New Things

Leadership

Good Communication

Managing Information

Diplomacy

Good Listener

Patience

Professional Skills

Analytical Thinking

Research & Data Interpretation

Communication

Teamwork

Time Management

Event Co-ordination

Safety Supervision

Editing & Proofreading

Other Interests

- Art
 - Photography
 - Travel
 - Books

- Science
 - Astronomy
 - Gaming

Awards & Honours

2025	University Medal Toowoomba, QLD University of Southern Queensland Awarded for outstanding academic achievement across the Bachelor of Science (Honours) program, recognising the highest level of academic performance in the graduating cohort.
2025	First Class Honours Toowoomba, QLD University of Southern Queensland Achieved First Class Honours for research investigating the distribution of star formation in merging galaxies, demonstrating strong capability in independent scientific research and analysis.
2026	Forging Forward Bursary QLD Queensland Government, Office for Women and Economic Security Awarded a bursary and certificate in recognition of achievement and potential, supporting continued progression in postgraduate research.

Information Technology Skills

Data Analysis	VisualStudio: Advanced Jupiter Notebook: Advanced
Image Processing	Adobe Photoshop : Advanced PixInsight : Intermediate
Office Automation	MS Office (Excel, Word, PowerPoint): Advanced LaTeX: Intermediate

Programming Languages

- Python: Advanced
 - R: Basic
 - SQL: Intermediate